

Subject Code [2508000705020001]

Veer Narmad South Gujarat University
Major : DSCC-12 – Research Methodology

Course	Core (Major) DSCC-12
Course Title	Research Methodology
Credit	4
Teaching per Week	4
Review / Revision	June, 2025
Minimum weeks / Semester	15 (Lectures, Guest Lectures, Case Study, Presentations, Group Assignments)
Medium of Instruction	English
Purpose of Course	• The purpose of the course is to explain to the students' application of research in business management.
Course Objective	• To acquaint students with the basic procedure of scientific business research • To orient students with the methodology of research in a way that they can do their semester six project report work in an effective manner
Course Outcome	• Students should be able to understand the basic nature and purpose of Research and its advantages to business • To understand the purpose of Sampling and Sampling Techniques in the process of research design • To understand various Primary and Secondary sources of data • To understand how to do Data Processing • To learn how to write a Research Report

Course Content

Unit 1: Introduction to Business Research

(25%)

- Bharatiya Knowledge System in Research Methodology : Pramanas (Epistemological Tools in BKS RM) & Relevance to Modern Research Methodology: Pratyaksha (Direct Perception), Anumana (Inference), Upamana (Comparison/Analogy), Arthapatti (Postulation/Presumption), Anupalabdi (Non-Perception), Shabda (Verbal Testimony)
- Concept & Definition of Business Research
- Classification of Business research viz. Basic vs. Applied Research,
- Problem Identification vs. Problem Solving Research,
- Cross Sectional vs. Longitudinal Research,
- Quantitative Vs. Qualitative Research
- Methods of Knowing: Scientific & Non-Scientific methods (Name the types of non-scientific methods only)
- Characteristics of a good scientific research
- Types of research design (Exploratory and Conclusive)
- Different types of errors in business research
- Meaning of terms: "Concept", "Construct" and "Definition" in relation to business research
- Different types of variables in business research
- Definition of hypothesis
- Types of hypotheses
- Role of hypothesis in research
- Qualities of a good hypothesis
- Business Research Process



Unit 2: Data Collection**(25%)**

- Difference between terms: "Data" and "Information",
- Difference between Primary Data & Secondary Data. Their relative merits & de-merits,
- Various sources of secondary data (Internal & External)
- General Idea of survey methods
- Four Survey Methods viz. Telephonic Survey, Personal Survey, Electronic Survey and Mail Survey,
- Comparison of four survey methods on various parameters - Social desirability, Perceived Anonymity, Response Rate, Control on data collection environment, Diversity of questions, Interviewer's bias, Use of physical stimuli, Sample control, quantum of data
- Definition of Observation : When observation method is suitable, Advantages and Limitations of Observation Method

Unit 3: Sampling and Scaling Methods.**(25%)**

- Difference between Sample and Census
- Sampling Procedure
- Probabilistic and Non- Probabilistic Sampling Methods
- Meaning of scale and Attitude scale
- Types of primary scale (Nominal, ordinal, interval, ratio)
- Various Comparative and Non-comparative attitude Scales

Unit 4: Design of Questionnaire, Data preparation and Report writing**(25%)**

- **Design of Questionnaire:** Definition of Questionnaire, Process of questionnaire design,
- **Data Preparation:** Process of Data Preparation (Questionnaire Checking, Editing, Coding, Transcribing, Data Cleaning, Statistical Adjusting the data),
- **Report writing:** Types of research report, Contents/format of research report)

Suggested Readings:

1. Business Research Methods: Donald Cooper & Schindler, Tata McGraw Hill (Main Text)
2. Marketing Research: Naresh Malhotra, Pearson Publications (Second Text)
3. Marketing Research: Churchill, Dryden Press, Harcourt Publications
4. Business Research Methods: Zikmund , Cengage Publishing
5. Business Research Methods: Saunders, Pearson Publications
6. Marketing Research : G. C. Beri, Tata McGraw Hill Education
7. G.P. Bhatta : Epistemology of Bhatta School of Purva Mimamsa, Chowkhamba Publication

